



My Placement Interview Experience

About Tekion

Tekion is a cutting-edge technology company that provides innovative solutions for the automotive industry. Founded in 2016 and headquartered in California, Tekion leverages cloud, AI, ML, and modern architecture to transform the automotive retail experience. It is known for its fast-paced, product-driven culture and emphasis on innovation.

1. Online Assessment (Round 1)

- The **online assessment was conducted on HackerRank**.
- It contained a total of **12 questions**:
 - **10 Technical MCQs**.
 - **1 SQL Query** (easy-level).
 - **1 DSA Problem** (coding).

DSA Question Asked

Problem Statement: You are given an integer array `arr[]` of size `n` and an integer `k`. Your task is to find the **minimum length subarray** of `arr` that contains all **`k` consecutive integers** (numbers forming a continuous range of length `k`).

The subarray does **not** need to have elements in sorted order. If no such subarray exists, return `-1`.

Example:

Input: `arr = [7, 3, 5, 6, 4, 9]`
`k = 3`

Explanation:

- Subarray `[3,5,6,4]` → contains `{3,4,5,6}` → includes `{3,4,5}` → length = 4
- Subarray `[5,6,4]` → contains `{4,5,6}` → ✓ valid, length = 3 (minimum so far)
- Subarray `[7,3,5,6,4]` → contains `{3,4,5,6,7}` → length = 5

Minimum length = 3

2. Interview at CUIC

i) Offline Coding Round 1

Frontend Section: - Task: Create a dynamic form builder using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.

- Focus: DOM manipulation, event handling.

Backend Section: - Two coding problems:

1. **Buy and Sell Stock II (LeetCode):** Find maximum profit with unlimited transactions using a greedy approach.

2. **User Activity Log Analysis:** Two files (Day 1 and Day 2) with timestamped user visits. Retrieve users visiting **two different pages on both days**. Initially solved with Python file handling, then re-implemented using **CSV format**.

ii) Offline Coding Round 2 (DSA Focused)

1. **Word Break II (LeetCode)** - Input: string *s* and wordDict. Return all sentences by inserting spaces so every word exists in wordDict. Words can be reused. - Example: *s* = "catsanddog", wordDict = ["cat","cats","and","sand","dog"] → Output: ["cats and dog","cat sand dog"] - Solved using **recursion with backtracking**.

2. **Longest String with Limited Character Repetition** - Input: integers *a*, *b*, *c* for counts of 'a', 'b', 'c'. Construct the **longest string without three consecutive identical letters**. - Example: *a* = 1, *b* = 1, *c* = 7 → Output: ccbccacc - Solved using a **priority queue (max-heap)** strategy.

iii) Technical Interview

1. Resume & Projects:

- Questions were mostly based on my resume.
- The interviewer asked deep questions about my projects, such as:
- Why I chose a particular tech stack for a project.
- How I implemented certain features.
- Why I used SQL instead of NoSQL, or other database design choices.
- This round tested clarity of thought and justification for design decisions.

2. **React.js Questions:** Questions were asked to test my understanding of React.js fundamentals.

3. **Scenario-Based Questions:** Real-time scenario questions were given to evaluate problem-solving and SQL skills.

4. **DSA Questions:** Tree traversal questions were asked to test fundamental algorithmic knowledge.

5. Puzzle:

You have two ropes of different lengths. Each rope takes exactly 1 hour to burn, but the burning rate is not uniform. You need to find the middle point of one rope using the other.

I was unable to solve it initially. The interviewer explained:

- Burn one rope from both ends. When it finishes, exactly half of the other rope has burned.
 - He related this concept to slow and fast pointer technique in finding the middle of a linked list.
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iv) HR Interview

1. **Introduction & Self-Intro:**

- The HR started with an introduction about the company.
- I was asked to give a self-introduction.

2. **Project Discussion:**

Questions about my project included:

- When I did the project.
- Why I chose that problem statement.
- Number of team members and who was the team leader.
- Challenges faced during the project.
- Unique features of my project.

3. **Understanding of Tekion:**

- I was asked about my knowledge and understanding of Tekion.
- They also asked about three aspirations or reasons for wanting to join Tekion.

4. **Extracurriculars & Hobbies:**

- Questions about participation in technical and non-technical events, hackathons, and competitions during college.
- Hobbies mentioned in my intro, like chess and sudoku, were discussed.
- She asked about tournaments or competitions I attended in chess and sudoku.

5. **Situational Question:**

- “You and your teammates have completed a project, but you don’t know about testing. What would you do?”
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3. Key Suggestions and Tips from My Experience

1. **Be strong in DSA and problem-solving:** Arrays, strings, recursion, backtracking, priority queues, tree traversals.
 2. **Be clear about everything in your resume:** Skills, projects, tech stack, challenges, unique features.
 3. **Prepare separate self-intros for technical and HR rounds:** Technical intro – projects and skills; HR intro – academics, hobbies, extracurriculars.
 4. **Be confident:** Explain your approach logically.
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Wishing you all the very best for your placements!